

DISC INDEX

Kim Michael Caro

April 8, 2026

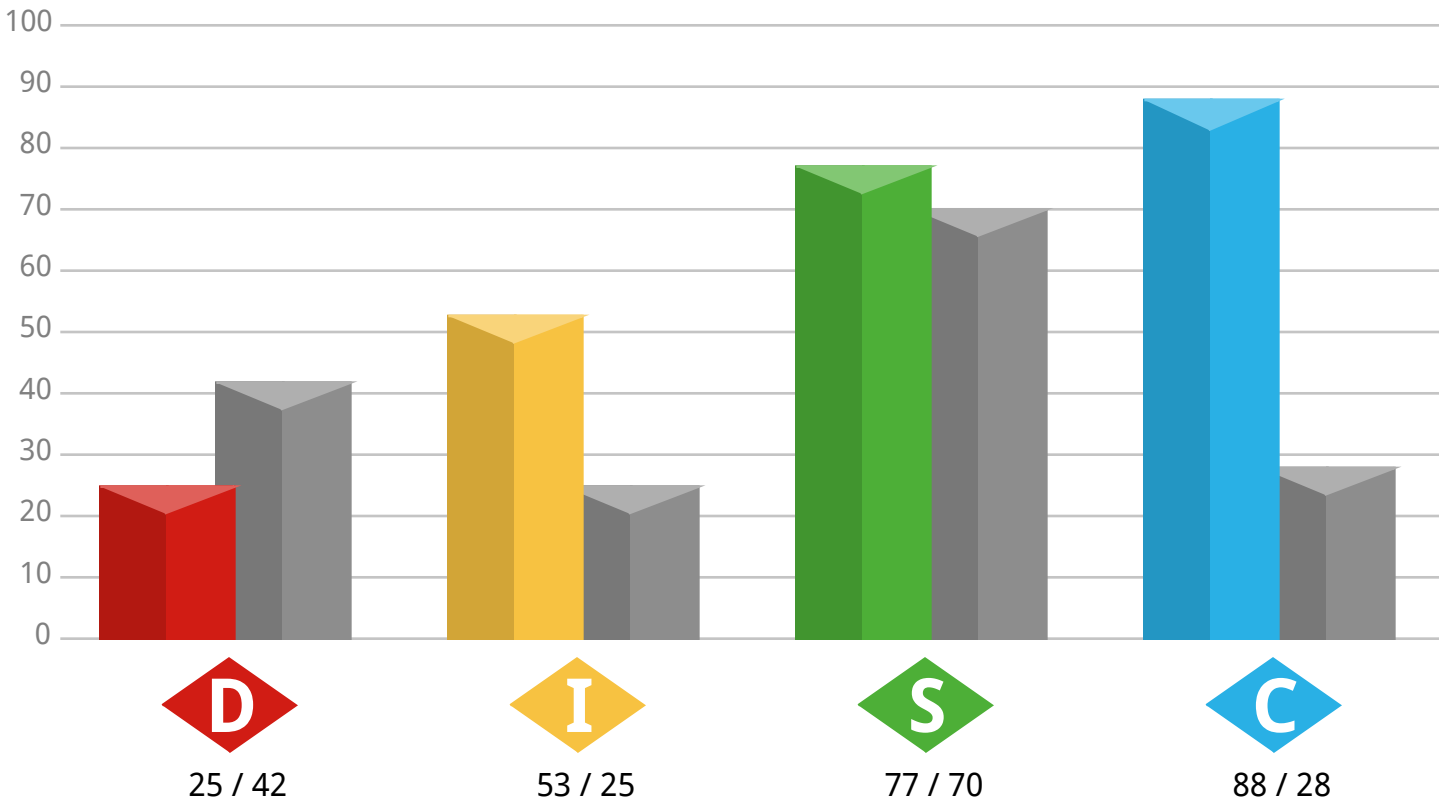
This Innermetrix Disc Index was authored by Jay Niblick, the Founder and CEO of Innermetrix. It is a modern interpretation of Dr. William Marston's behavioral dimensions. Marston's research uncovered four quadrants of behavior which help to understand a person's behavioral preferences. This Disc Index will help you understand your behavioral style and how to maximize your potential.

DISCPlusProfiles.com

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Natural and Adaptive Styles Comparison



Natural Style: The natural style is how you behave when you are being most natural. It is your basic style and the one you adopt when you are being authentic and true to yourself. It is also the style that you revert to when under stress or pressure. Behaving in this style, however, reduces your stress and tension and is comforting. When authentic to this style you will maximize your true potential more effectively.

Adaptive Style:
The adaptive style is how you behave when you feel you are being observed or how you behave when you are aware of your behavior. This style is less natural and less authentic for you or your true tendencies and preferences. When forced to adapt to this style for too long you may become stressed and less effective.

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About This Report

Research conducted by Innermetrix shows that the most successful people share the common trait of self-awareness. They recognize the situations that will make them successful, and this makes it easy for them to find ways of achieving objectives that fit their behavioral style. They also understand their limitations and where they are not effective and this helps them understand where not to go or how not to be as well. Those who understand their natural behavioral preferences are far more likely to pursue the right opportunities, in the right way, at the right time, and get the results they desire.

This report measures four dimensions of your behavioral style. They are:

- **D**ecisive — your preference for problem solving and getting results
- **I**nteractive — your preference for interacting with others and showing emotion
- **S**tability — your preference for pacing, persistence and steadiness
- **C**autious — your preference for procedures, standards and protocols

This report includes:

- **The Elements of DISC** — Educational background behind the profile, the science and the four dimensions of behavior
- **The DISC Dimensions** — A closer look at each of your four behavioral dimensions
- **Style Summary** — A comparison of your natural and adaptive behavioral styles
- **Behavioral Strengths** — A detailed strengths-based description of your overall behavioral style
- **Communication** — Tips on how you like to communicate and be communicated with
- **Ideal Job Climate** — Your ideal work environment
- **Effectiveness** — Insights into how you can be more effective by understanding your behavior
- **Behavioral Motivations** — Ways to ensure your environment is motivational
- **Continual Improvement** — Areas where you can focus on improving
- **Training & Learning Style** — Your preferred means of sharing and receiving styles
- **Relevance Section** — Making the information real and pertinent to you
- **Success Connection** — Connecting your style to your own life

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The Elements of the DISC-Index

This DISC-Index report is unique in the marketplace for a number of reasons. You just completed the first ever click & drag DISC instrument on the market. This was constructed in a precise manner to allow for ease of responses, even in the midst of many difficult decisions. This intuitive interface allows you to focus on your answers, not the process.

Also, unlike other DISC instruments, this instrument allows you to rank all four items instead. As a result, this instrument produces zero waste in responses. Some instruments ask you to choose two items out of four, and leave two items blank. Those instruments have a 50% waste of terms, and do not provide for an efficient response process. The DISC Index instrument eliminates that response problem.

Another unique aspect of this DISC-Index report is that we present the DISC aspects of your behavior both as separate entities and as a dynamic combination of traits. This report presents the first time that each of the DISC elements are separated and developed as pure entities of themselves. This can serve as an important learning tool as you explore the deeper aspects of DISC. Your unique pattern of DISC traits is developed through the context of this report. Additionally, the following four pages will be devoted to exploring your DISC scores as separate components within the unique combination of traits that you exhibit.

A comment on contradictions: You may read some areas of this report that may contradict other text. This is due to the fact that many of us show contradictory behaviors in the normal course of our daily operations. Each of us are at times talkative and other times more reflective, depending on how we are adapting our behavior. The expression of these contradictions is a demonstration of the sensitivity of this instrument to determine these subtle differences in our natural and adaptive style.

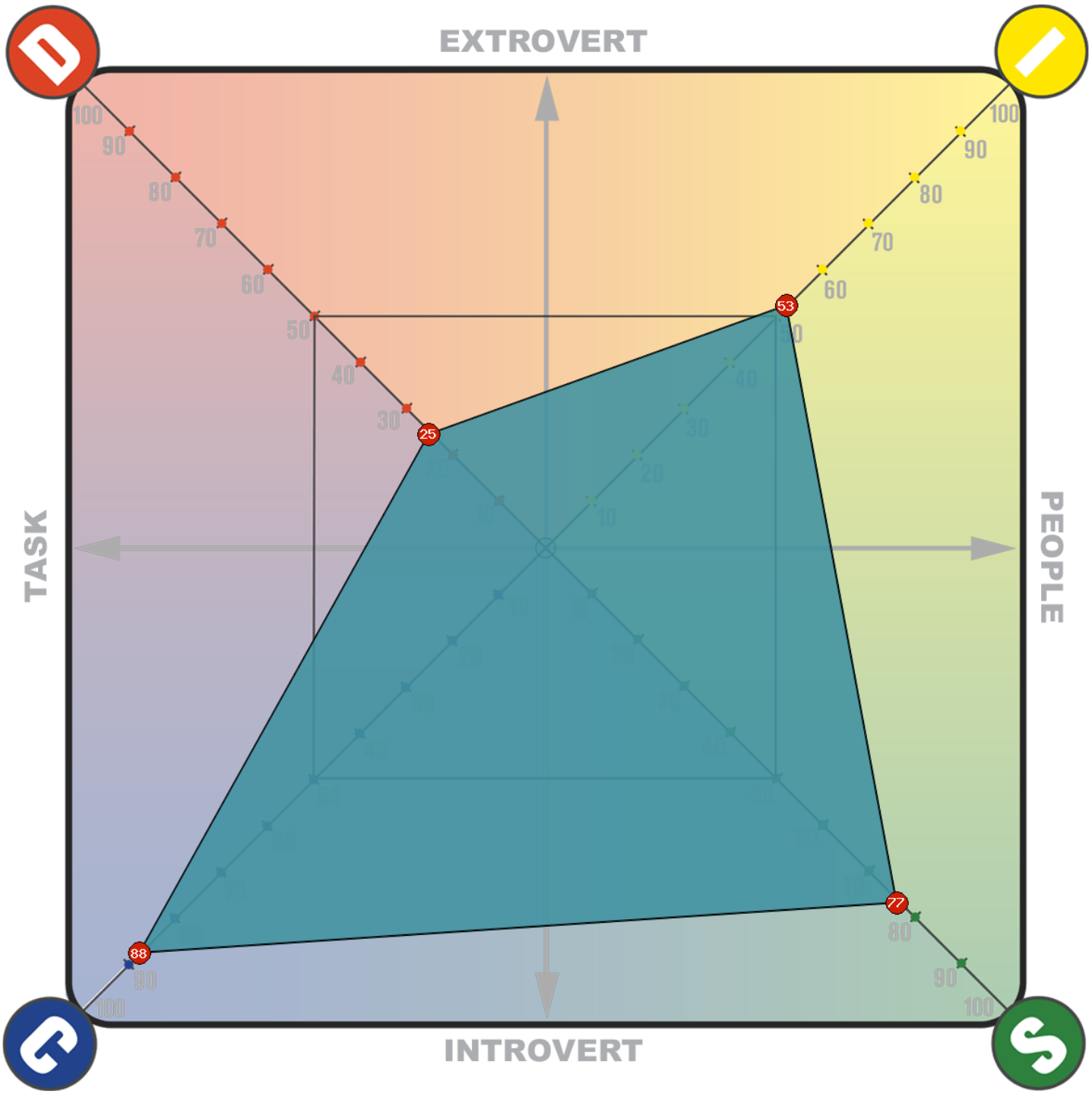
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A closer look at the four components of your behavioral style

Decisive	Interactive	Stabilizing	Cautious
Problems:	**People:**	**Pace:**	**Procedures:**
How you tend to approach problems and make decisions	How you tend to interact with others and share opinions	How you tend to pace things in your environment	Your preference for established protocol/ standards
High D	**High I**	**High S**	**High C**
Demanding	**Gregarious**	**Patient**	**Cautious**
Driving	Persuasive	Predictable	Perfectionist
Forceful	Inspiring	Passive	Systematic
Daring	Enthusiastic	Complacent	Careful
Determined	Sociable	Stable	Analytical
Competitive	Poised	Consistent	Orderly
Responsible	Charming	Steady	Neat
Inquisitive	Convincing	Outgoing	Balanced
Conservative	Reflective	Restless	Independent
Mild	Matter-of-fact	Active	Rebellious
Agreeable	Reserved	Chaotic	Careless
Deliberate	**Introspective**	**Spontaneous**	**Challenging**
Low D	**Low I**	**Low S**	**Low C**

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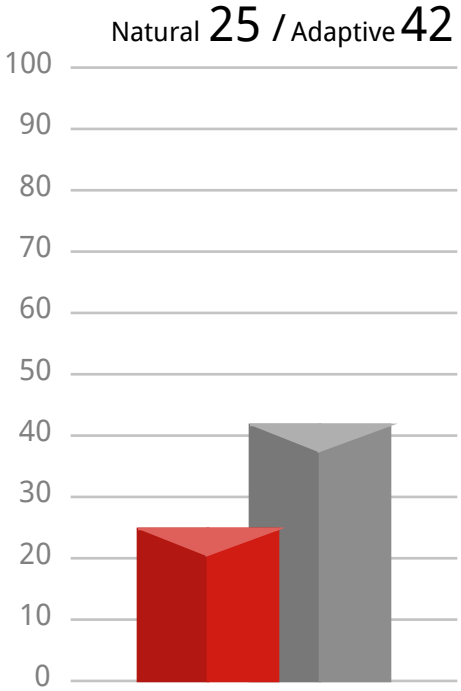
Decisive

Your approach to problem-solving and obtaining results

The D in DISC represents Decisiveness. Your score on this scale, represented below, shows your location on the D spectrum based on the pattern of your responses. A high score doesn't mean good, and a low score doesn't mean bad, as this is a spectrum or continuum of behavioral traits. For example:

Higher D —
Tend to solve new problems very quickly and assertively. They take an active and direct approach to obtaining results. The key here is new problems such as those that are unprecedented or haven't happened before. There may also be an element of risk in taking the wrong approach or developing an incorrect solution, but those with a High D score are willing to take those risks, even if they may be incorrect.

Lower D —
Tend to solve new problems in a more deliberate, controlled, and organized manner. Again, the key here is new and unprecedented problems. The Lower D style will solve routine problems very quickly because the outcomes are already known. But, when the outcomes are unknown and the problem is an uncertain one, the Lower D style will approach the new problem in a calculated and deliberate manner by thinking things through very carefully before acting.



Your score shows a moderately low score on the 'D' spectrum. The comments below highlight some of the traits specific to just your unique score.

- You can be overly self-critical of your ability on certain issues or tasks.
- You appreciate being thorough and complete in the analysis of all variables before making a decision.
- You tend to be more modest than egocentric in dealing with others.
- You may be prone to avoiding difficult decisions, and this can create delays.
- Unless completely wrong, you prefer to support decisions made by others rather than argue or disagree.
- You like an environment where authority and responsibility is mutual and shared across all members.

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Interactive

Your approach to interacting with people and display of emotions

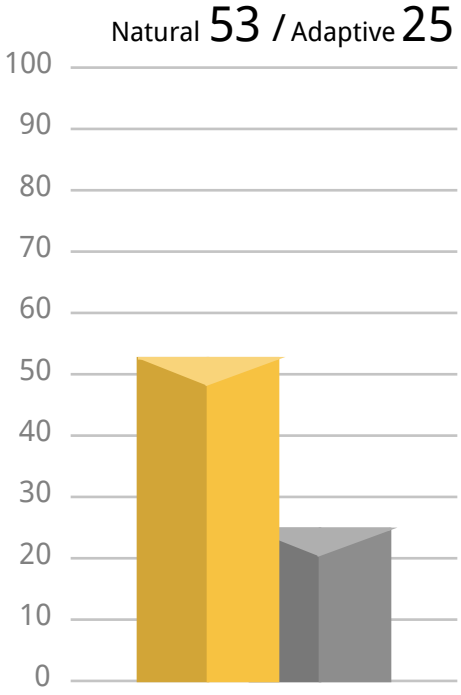
The I in DISC represents Interactive. Your score on this scale represented below shows your location on the I spectrum based on the pattern of your responses. A high score doesn't mean good, and a low score doesn't mean bad, as this is a spectrum or continuum of behavioral traits. For example:

Higher I —

Tend to meet new people in an outgoing, gregarious, and socially assertive manner. The key here is new people whom one hasn't met before. Many other styles are talkative, but more so with people that they've known for some time. The Higher I scores are talkative, interactive and open even with people whom they have just initially met. People scoring in this range may also be a bit impulsive. Generally speaking, those with the Higher I scores are generally talkative and outgoing.

Lower I —

Tend to meet new people in a more controlled, quiet and reserved manner. Here's where the key word "new people" enters the equation. Those with Lower I scores are talkative with their friends and close associates, but tend to be more reserved with people they've just recently met. They tend to place a premium on the control of emotions, and approach new relationships with a more reflective approach than an emotional one.



Your score shows a high average score on the 'I' spectrum. The comments below highlight some of the traits specific to just your unique score.

- You can be an effective coach or counselor for others.
- You prefer an environment with ample people contact.
- You could be a bit more organized and attentive to details.
- You like a flexible environment that allows for creativity.
- You like democratic not dictatorial relationships on the job.
- People may find you charming to meet and to converse with on a variety of topics.

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Stabilizing

Your approach to the pace of the work environment

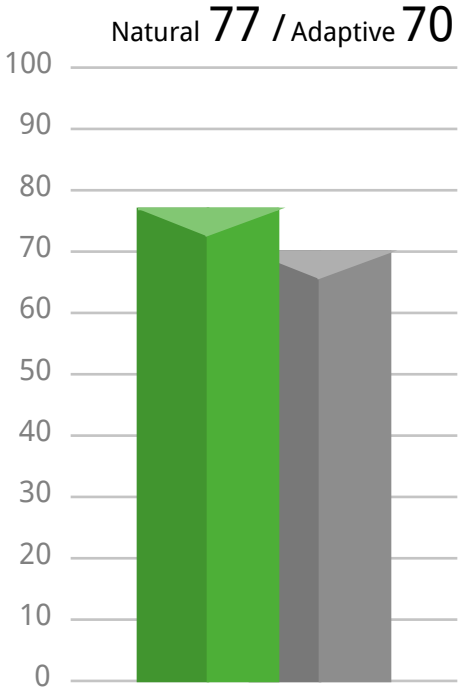
The S in DISC represents Stabilizing. Your score on this scale represented below shows your location on the S spectrum based on the pattern of your responses. A high score doesn't mean good, and a low score doesn't mean bad, as this is a spectrum or continuum of behavioral traits. For example:

Higher S —

Tend to prefer a more controlled, deliberative and predictable environment. They place a premium on security of a work situation and disciplined behavior. They also tend to show a sense of loyalty to a team or organization, and as a result, may have a greater longevity or tenure in a position than some other styles. They have an excellent listening style and are very patient coaches and teachers for others on the team.

Lower S —

Tend to prefer a more flexible, dynamic, unstructured work environment. They value freedom of expression and the ability to change quickly from one activity to another. They tend to become bored with the same routine that brings security to the Higher S traits. As a result, they will seek opportunities and outlets for their high sense of urgency and high activity levels, as they have a preference for spontaneity.



Your score shows a moderately high score on the 'S' spectrum. The comments below highlight some of the traits specific to just your unique score.

- You tend to resist confronting or rebelling against the established norm.
- You can be fairly resistant to change.
- Increasing your sense of urgency could benefit your performance in many instances.
- You strongly prefer a workplace with a sincere, personal, and agreeable environment with little hostility.
- You always present a more relaxed and open approach to your work and how fast you must get it done.
- You bring a high sense of loyalty to the rules and regulations that govern projects, people, and processes.

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Cautious

Your approach to standards, procedures, and expectations

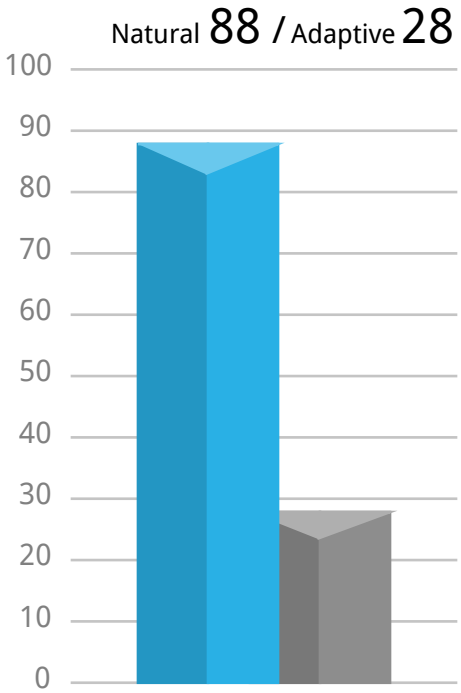
The C in DISC represents Cautiousness. Your score on the scale represented below shows your location on the C spectrum based on the pattern of your responses. A high score doesn't mean good, and a low score doesn't mean bad, as this is a spectrum or continuum of behavioral traits. For example:

Higher C —

Tend to adhere to rules, standards, procedures, and protocol set by those in authority whom they respect. They like things to be done the right way according to the operating manual. "Rules are made to be followed" is an appropriate motto for those with higher C scores. They have some of the highest quality control interests of any of the styles and frequently wish others would do the same.

Lower C —

Tend to operate more independently from the rules and standard operating procedures. They tend to be bottom-line oriented. If they find an easier way to do something, they'll do it by developing a variety of strategies as situations demand. To the Lower C scores, rules are only guidelines, and may be bent or broken as necessary to obtain results.



Your score shows a very high score on the 'C' spectrum. The comments below highlight some of the traits specific to just your unique score.

- You are most likely seen as being more resistant to change than others.
- You like things to be done the "right" way according to standard operating procedure.
- You prefer to have the complete picture before beginning with any task or process.
- You are very systematic and like to analyze details to accomplish a process correctly.
- You can express your disagreement in a passive-aggressive way.
- You have a strong preference for adhering to established rules, regulations and protocols that have been proven to work.

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Natural Style Pattern:

Your natural style is the way you tend to behave when you aren't thinking about it. This is where you are most comfortable (natural). This is also the style you will revert back to when under stress or moving too quickly to be consciously thinking about modifying your behavior. Finally, this is the style you should seek to be true to in your daily roles. Being natural will return better results with less effort and stress. The following statements are true to just your unique natural style:

- Tend to be more modest than egocentric, but you also have the ability to become assertive when necessary for emphasis or communication.
- You have the ability to self-manage much of your own organizational activity and workload.
- Tend to be optimistic and demonstrate high personal standards and set high goals for yourself.
- You have a large knowledge-base and a continuing appetite to learn more.
- May become verbally disappointed when standards aren't met, or when the team project becomes delayed.
- You demonstrate a high degree of competence in your area of expertise.
- Response pattern indicates that you have the ability to be a strong achiever in technical performance and expertise within the organization.
- You tend to be verbal and articulate about many different topics and issues.

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Adaptive Style Pattern:

This is the style of behavior you adapt to when you are conscious of your own behavior, when you feel you are being observed or whenever you are trying to better fit a situation. This is not a natural style for you, but still one of your two styles none-the-less. In other words, it is the way you feel you "should" behave when thinking about it. The statements below are specific to your individual Adaptive style:

- You are seen by others as one who is down-to-earth, approachable, and technically competent in your areas of authority and responsibility.
- You tend to be more modest than egocentric, and as a result you are able to work well with a variety of other DISC-Index™ style preferences.
- Known to say 'yes' more than 'no' when asked to help out with a colleague's project or problem.
- Works very effectively in specialized areas of work processes, and may serve as the 'glue' that holds a complex project together.
- Tends to have deep family connections, and may hesitate to travel for extended periods of time away from the family.
- Once you have established a project routine, pattern, or rhythm, you have a remarkable ability to follow that pattern or procedure with enduring patience.
- Respects the organizational operating protocol as it is. "If is isn't broken, don't try to fix it."
- Known by others in the organization to have a 'long fuse' and is not easily angered while on the job, although may take some of the anger and vent it at home.

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Based on your behavioral style there are certain opportunities for becoming more effective by being aware of how you prefer, and enjoy, to behave. The items below may assist you in your professional development growth. By understanding these items you may find explanations for why you may be stuck in some areas of your life and why other aspects give you no trouble at all. You could be more effective by:

- An increased sense of urgency to get things done... now.
- Work assignments of high precision and accuracy to capitalize on your high detail orientation.
- Becoming more comfortable with faster decision-making.
- Greater participation in team efforts and activities.
- Associating with friendly, active people.
- Complete explanations of the nature of a process or systems used.
- An environment with minimal sudden changes and crises.
- Clear and specific job descriptions, and role responsibilities.

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Your behavioral style will cause you to be motivated by certain factors in your environment. Having these present may make you feel more motivated, and productive. The following are things that you may want in your surroundings to feel optimally motivated:

- Projects and challenges of a specialized nature to demonstrate skills and competence.
- A link to some of the successful traditions that have built success in the past.
- Sufficient time to adjust to change so as not to disrupt systems and processes.
- An environment with minimal interpersonal conflict and hostility.
- Established procedures on which a base of successful processes can be built.
- Sincerity from peers and colleagues.
- Identification with company and colleagues that one can be proud of.
- Appreciation for the competence and work ethic demonstrated over the long haul.

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Each behavioral style contains certain unique strengths as a result of how your four behavioral dimensions relate to each other. Understanding your own unique behavioral strengths is an important part of putting your new level of self-awareness to work for your success and satisfaction. The following statements highlight specific strengths of your behavioral style:

- People oriented in a stable and sincere way.
- Ready, willing, and able to assist others on the team with a specialized project. All they have to do is ask.
- Extensive base of both knowledge and expertise can be tapped to assist in getting a job done.
- Very proficient in your area of expertise.
- Maintains a stable and predictable pace to complete a complex or specialized project, and demonstrates a tireless work ethic to get the project finished.
- Frequently seen by others as an expert in your area of responsibility, and willing to share the expertise with others.
- Generates positive enthusiasm for a variety of projects in the organization.
- A keen awareness of the broad-based impact of important decisions.

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Your behavioral style plays a significant role in determining what aspects of an environment you like. The items below will help you understand what will define an ideal working climate for you. Based on how you prefer to behave, an ideal climate for you is one that provides you with:

- Work projects involving accuracy, consistent performance, and specialized skills.
- Operational procedures and policies that are clear, well-defined, and in writing.
- Sometimes working more with things than with people.
- Minimal interpersonal conflict and hostility.
- An ability to function effectively in the midst of some important and necessary, but sometimes very routine work procedures.
- An organizational culture that allows time to consider changes, rather than jumping into change.
- An appreciation of the very high degree of patience you bring to the job culture and sincerity in working with others.
- A culture that provides a relatively stable and predictable workplace environment with few sudden changes, even in the midst of high stakes or pressure.

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Along with strengths, all behavioral styles come with areas that could become weaknesses - if depended upon or not acknowledged. The trick is not to manufacture a weakness in the first place by depending on these things.

Here are a few items that could become problematic for you if not acknowledged or known. Your awareness of the potentials below is your best step in making sure they remain only potential problems. Due to your behavioral style, you may tend to:

- Get overly bogged down in details, especially when the climate becomes pressured.
- Struggle with prioritizing things appropriately, due to ranking all items as the "most important".
- Promise a bit more than you can deliver, bite off more than you can chew.
- Hold a bit of a grudge.
- Take criticism personally, even though it was directed at a work process.
- Overestimate the ability of others.
- Hang on too much to current or past procedures, especially when faced with impending change.
- Set unreasonable expectations of the capability or capacity of others on the team.

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Based on how you tend to behave you have certain preferences for how you like to convey information, teach, instruct or share knowledge with others. This is also true of how you like to receive information and learn. Understanding your behavioral preferences here will help increase your effectiveness in teaching or instructing others, and in being taught and learning.

How you prefer to share knowledge or teach:

- Presents detailed information in a logical and sequential manner.
- Wants to provide participants with the ability to understand principles and concepts.
- Balances individual and group work for the participants.
- Leads through factual and emotional persuasion.
- Brings imagination and ideas to the training event.
- Prefers explicit instructions and measurement criteria to be established with the participants.
- Wants to know performance outcomes, objectives, etc., and communicates these to the participants.

How you prefer to receive knowledge or learn:

- Likes active testing of ideas and experiences.
- Sincere participation with others.
- High expectations of performance.
- Prefers traditional learning structure and activities.
- Integrates experiences with practical applications and ideas.
- Shows commitment, and wants to be personally involved in learning.
- More accepting of a more impersonal training or learning venue than others.

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This page is unique in this report because it is the only one that doesn't speak directly to you, rather to those who interact with you. The information below will help others communicate with you more effectively by appealing to your natural behavioral style. The first items are things others SHOULD do to be better understood by you (Do's) and the second list is of things others SHOULD NOT do (Don'ts) if they want you to understand them well.

Things to do to effectively communicate with you:

- Provide testimonials from people seen as important and prominent.
- Use the conversation to direct you back to the topic or issue at hand.
- Do your homework, because others will have already done their share of it.
- Outline individual tasks and responsibilities in writing.
- If you say you're going to do something, do it.
- Offer input on how to make the ideas become reality.
- Provide assurances about input and decisions.

Things to avoid to effectively communicate with you:

- Don't stick too rigidly to the agenda.
- Don't stick to a strictly business agenda. Loosen up a little.
- Don't fail to follow through. If you say you're going to do something, do it.
- Don't use someone else's opinions as evidence.
- Don't leave the idea or plan without backup support.
- Don't be rude, abrupt, or too fast-paced in your delivery.
- Don't rush the issues or the decision-making process.

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In order to make the most out of the information in this report it is important that you connect it to your life in a tangible way. To help you make this information your own, and pull out the most relevant parts, fill in the blanks below.

Decisiveness:
How is your 'D' score relevant to your life?

_____

Interacting:
How is your 'I' score relevant to your life?

_____

Stabilizing:
How is your 'S' score relevant to your life?

_____

Cautiousness:
How is your 'C' score relevant to your life?

_____

Overall Natural Style:
What is one way in which your natural style relates to your life?

_____

Overall Adaptive Style:
What is one way in which your adaptive style relates to your life?

_____

Strength-based insights:
What specific strengths do you think connect to your success more than any other?

_____

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Communication Dos and Don'ts:

What did you learn from understanding your preferred communication style?

_____

Ideal Job Climate:

How well does your current climate fit your behavioral style?

_____

Effectiveness:

What is one way in which you could become more effective?

_____

Motivation:

How can you stay more motivated?

_____

Improvement:

What is something you learned that you can use to improve your performance?

_____

Training/Learning:

What did you learn that could help you instruct others better, or learn more effectively?

_____

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Your final step to making sure you really benefit from the information in this report is to understand how your behavioral style contributes to, and perhaps hinders, your overall success.

Supporting Success:

Overall, how can your unique behavioral style support your success? (cite specific examples)

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Limiting Success:

Overall, how could your unique behavioral style get in the way of your success? (cite specific examples)

_____

_____

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